FLASHBACK

➢ How to enable Flashback?

STEP 1: Check the flashback status.

```
SQL> SELECT FLASHBACK_ON FROM V$DATABASE;

FLASHBACK_ON
------------------
NO
```

STEP 2: Open the flashback.

```
SQL> SHU IMMEDIATE;
Database closed.
Database dismounted.
ORACLE instance shut down.
SQL>
SQL> STARTUP MOUNT;
ORACLE instance started.

Total System Global Area  310377856 bytes
Fixed Size                  8895872 bytes
Variable Size             272629760 bytes
Database Buffers           25165824 bytes
Redo Buffers                3686400 bytes
Database mounted.
SQL>
SQL> ALTER DATABASE FLASHBACK ON;

Database altered.

SQL> ALTER DATABASE OPEN;

Database altered.

SQL> SELECT FLASHBACK_ON FROM V$DATABASE;

FLASHBACK_ON
------------------
YES
```

➢ How to check flashback is enabled or disabled?

```
SQL> SELECT FLASHBACK_ON FROM V$DATABASE;

FLASHBACK_ON
------------------
YES
```

➢ How to flashback a dropped table from recycle bin?

STEP 1: check table

```
SQL> SELECT * FROM DEADLOCK_TEST;

        ID NAME
---------- ------------
         1 AYAN
         2 BRINDA
```

STEP 2: Drop the table.

```
SQL> DROP TABLE DEADLOCK_TEST;

Table dropped.
```

STEP 3: Check the recycle bin.

```
SQL> SELECT ORIGINAL_NAME,OBJECT_NAME FROM USER_RECYCLEBIN;

ORIGINAL_NAME                    OBJECT_NAME
-------------------------------- ---------------------------------------------------
SYS_C007618                      BIN$U/21l9P5BKXgZQAAAAAAAQ==$0
DEADLOCK_TEST                    BIN$U/21l9P6BKXgZQAAAAAAAQ==$0
```

STEP 4: Flashback the drop table.

```
SQL>
SQL> FLASHBACK TABLE "BIN$U/21l9P6BKXgZQAAAAAAAQ==$0" TO BEFORE DROP;

Flashback complete.

SQL>
SQL> SELECT * FROM DEADLOCK_TEST;

        ID NAME
---------- --------------------
         1 AYAN
         2 BRINDA
```

➢ How to purge recycle bin?

STEP 1: Check the recycle bin value.

```
SQL> SELECT ORIGINAL_NAME,OBJECT_NAME FROM USER_RECYCLEBIN;

ORIGINAL_NAME                    OBJECT_NAME
-------------------------------- ---------------------------------------------------
TEST                             BIN$U/3eS3JeFrfgZQAAAAAAAQ==$0
```

STEP 2: Purge the value from recycle bin.

```
SQL> purge recyclebin;

Recyclebin purged.

SQL> SELECT ORIGINAL_NAME,OBJECT_NAME FROM USER_RECYCLEBIN;

no rows selected
```

➢ How to Flashback Database to SCN?

STEP 1: Check Available Flashback Logs.

SELECT OLDEST_FLASHBACK_SCN, OLDEST_FLASHBACK_TIME FROM V$FLASHBACK_DATABASE_LOG;

```
SQL> SELECT OLDEST_FLASHBACK_SCN, OLDEST_FLASHBACK_TIME FROM V$FLASHBACK_DATABASE_LOG;

OLDEST_FLASHBACK_SCN OLDEST_FL
-------------------- ---------
             3167128 11-JUN-26
```

STEP 2: Shutdown and Mount Database.

SHUTDOWN IMMEDIATE;
STARTUP MOUNT;

STEP 3: Flashback to a Specific SCN.

```
SQL> FLASHBACK DATABASE TO SCN 3167143;

Flashback complete.
```

STEP 4: Open the Database.

```
SQL> ALTER DATABASE OPEN RESETLOGS;

Database altered.
```

Note: After a successful Flashback Database operation, OPEN RESETLOGS is required.

OPEN RESETLOGS is required after **Flashback Database to an SCN or Timestamp** because Oracle is effectively creating a **new incarnation of the database**.

➢ How to Flashback Database to Timestamp?

STEP 1: Check Flashback Window.

```
SQL> SELECT OLDEST_FLASHBACK_TIME FROM V$FLASHBACK_DATABASE_LOG;

OLDEST_FL
---------
11-JUN-26
```

STEP 2: Shutdown and Mount Database.

SHUTDOWN IMMEDIATE;

STARTUP MOUNT;

STEP 3: Flashback to a Specific Timestamp

```
SQL> FLASHBACK DATABASE TO TIMESTAMP TO_TIMESTAMP('2026-06-11 10:35:00', 'YYYY-MM-DD HH24:MI:SS');
FLASHBACK DATABASE TO TIMESTAMP TO_TIMESTAMP('2026-06-11 10:35:00', 'YYYY-MM-DD HH24:MI:SS')
*
ERROR at line 1:
ORA-38729: Not enough flashback database log data to do FLASHBACK.
```

The error:

ORA-38729: Not enough flashback database log data to do FLASHBACK.

This means Oracle does not have sufficient flashback logs to rewind the database to:

TO_TIMESTAMP ('2026-06-11 10:35:00','YYYY-MM-DD HH24:MI:SS')

Why does this happen?

One of the following is usually true:

1. The requested timestamp is older than the oldest available flashback log.
2. Flashback logs were deleted because the FRA became full.
3. Flashback Database was enabled after the requested timestamp.
4. The flashback retention target was too small.

STEP 4: Check the Oldest Available Flashback Time.

```
SQL> SELECT OLDEST_FLASHBACK_SCN, TO_CHAR(OLDEST_FLASHBACK_TIME,'DD-MM-YYYY HH24:MI:SS') FROM V$FLASHBACK_DATABASE_LOG;

OLDEST_FLASHBACK_SCN TO_CHAR(OLDEST_FLAS
-------------------- -------------------
             3167128 11-06-2026 21:05:29
```

STEP 5: Check the system date & time.

```
SQL> SELECT TO_CHAR(SYSDATE,'DD-MM-YYYY HH24:MI:SS') FROM DUAL;

TO_CHAR(SYSDATE,'DD
-------------------
11-06-2026 22:48:16

SQL> FLASHBACK DATABASE TO TIMESTAMP TO_TIMESTAMP('11-JUN-26 22:48:00','DD-MON-YY HH24:MI:SS');

Flashback complete.
```

STEP 6: OPEN DATABASE

```
SQL> ALTER DATABASE OPEN RESETLOGS;

Database altered.
```